Bonding in acetylene:

Similar to ethylene, the bonding in acetylene can also be explained using hybridisation concept. The molecular formula of acetylene is C_2H_2. The electronic configuration of valence shell of carbon in ground state is $[He]2s^2\ 2p_x^1\ 2p_y^1\ 2p_z^0$. To satisfy the valency of carbon promote an electron from 2s orbital to $2p_z$ orbital in the excited state.

In acetylene molecule, both the carbon atoms are in sp hybridised state. The 2s and $2p_x$ orbitals, resulting in two equivalent sp hybridised orbitals lying in a straight line along the molecular axis (x-axis). The unhybridised $2p_y$ and $2p_z$ orbitals lie perpendicular to the molecular axis.

Formation of sigma bond:

One of the two sp hybridised orbitals of each carbon linearly overlaps with each other resulting in the formation a C-C sigma bond. The other sp hybridised orbital of both carbons linearly overlap with the two 1s orbitals of two hydrogen atoms leading to the formation of one C-H sigma bonds on each carbon.

Formation of pi bond:

The unhybridised $2p_y$ and $2p_z$ orbitals of each carbon overlap sideways. This lateral overlap results in the formation of two pi bonds (p_y-p_y and p_z-p_z) between the two carbon atoms as shown in the figure.

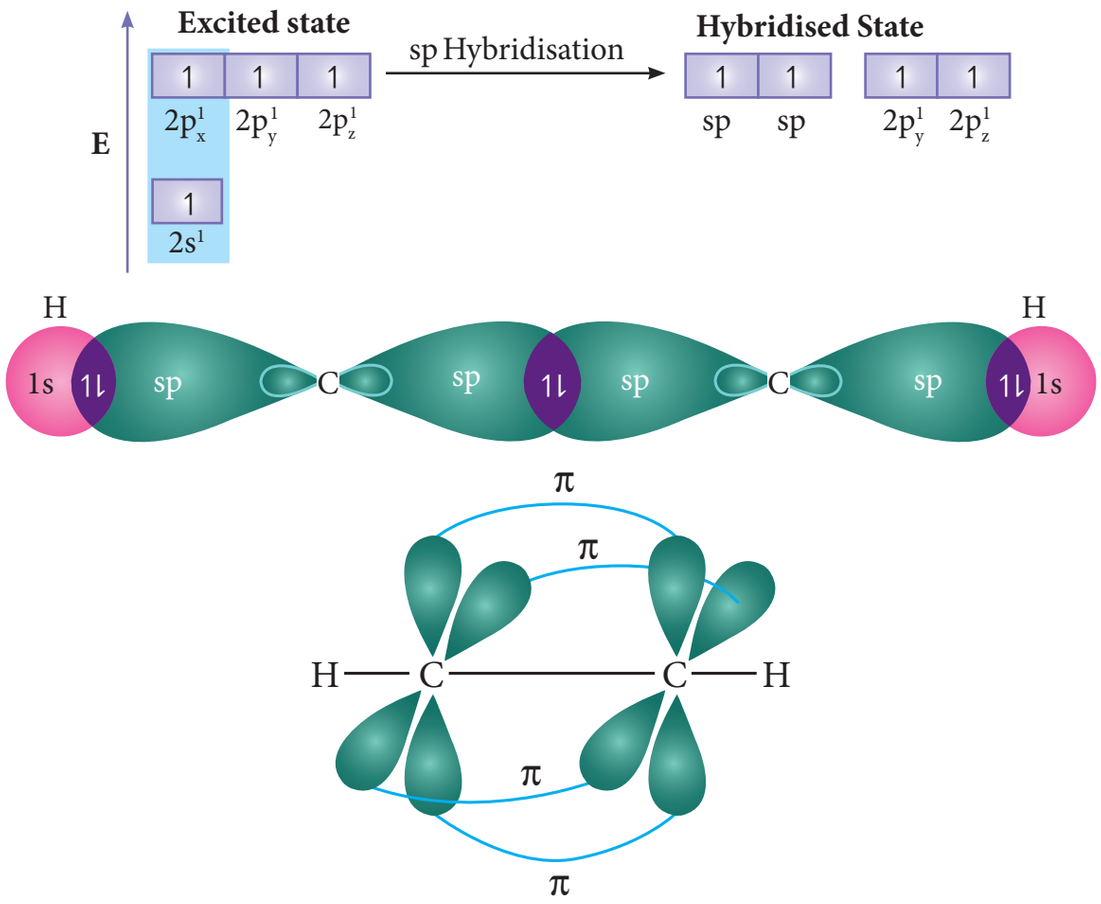


Fig 10.28 sp Hybridisation in acetylene: C_2H_2

Unit 10 layout - jagan.indd 96 22-01-2021 12:33:30